

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	SFT515
Subject Title	Historical Research Methodologies
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This subject aims to: 1. Provide an overview of methodologies used in visual analysis. 2. Equip students with the ability to articulate their analytical approach. 3. Encourage students to be objectively critical of methodologies. 4. Empower students to take an intellectual approach to designs and storytelling. 5. Develop an initial capstone project proposal.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Explore key critical methodologies used in visual analysis and learn to apply these to contemporary and historical examples. b) Provide in-depth analysis through a chosen methodology of a designer's work. c) Analyse cultural practice or historical events through a methodology combined with an esoteric concept. (For example, Freudian analysis and the Sublime) d) Analyse marketing and messaging from luxury brands to discern core designer concepts. e) Present a vision for their own practice grounded in an intellectual interrogation of their chosen source inspiration

	to be developed for their capstone project proposal.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	This compulsory course is designed to encourage an intellectual discovery process that will inspire more thoughtful and engaging design. Students will be introduced to core analytical methodologies used in art and fashion history and given the language and theories to interrogate their own practice and creative concepts. At the end of this course, students will have formulated their capstone project proposal through methods of effective storytelling. Topics covered in the lectures could include: 1. A survey of methodologies used in visual analysis Then each following week we will take a closer look at a methodology 2. Vasari, Biography and the masters (but make it fashion!): Chanel, Balenciaga and Dior. 3. Iconography: From religious art to the MET ball, how we encode and decode meaning. 4. Marxism in contemporary fast fashion. 5. Psychoanalytic theory and the uniform. 6. Post-colonial dress and cultural appropriation. 7. Performance in fashion: the McQueen catwalk as art. 8. Queer theory, drag costume and hyper-femininity. Exercises ○ Students will complete weekly readings to develop their understanding of the methodologies prior to each lecture. ○ Students will complete a short written analysis of catwalk shows and collections using designated methodologies. ○ They will also research and present a visual analysis highlighting a specific approach and storytelling technique. ○ A multiweek exercise will allow the students to develop a proposal for their capstone project using in-depth research and analysis, written essay and visual storytelling methodologies.
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	This online course combines presented lecturers, discussion, independent research and directed readings. Students will be encouraged to select a methodology and esoteric concept to use for their final research project. Recorded lectures are designed to introduce a new methodology each

	generated materials as students' own work or part of their work is an act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions. <u>Midterm Presentation 20%</u> The midterm presentation is a checkpoint for the first draft of their capstone proposal. This gives students an opportunity to get critical feedback from the faculty and cohort early enough to strengthen their proposal ideas and concepts. The materials submitted for this assessment must be the student's own work. The submitted work may not be accepted for the purpose of assessment if its authenticity is questionable. Submitting GenAI-generated materials as students' own work or part of their work is an act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions. <u>Capstone Proposal 50%</u> The capstone proposal will kickstart the development of their capstone project. In SFT527CP Capstone Project I, they will execute the proposal and start the exploration and planning of their final collection. The materials submitted for this assessment must be the student's own work. The submitted work may not be accepted for the purpose of assessment if its authenticity is questionable. Submitting GenAI-generated materials as students' own work or part of their work is an act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Online class contact:	
	▪ Lectures and Presentations	26 Hrs.
	▪ Discussions, critiques, shared discoveries etc.	13 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Exercises	19.5 Hrs.
	▪ Self-study and completing assignments	46.5 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	105 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Visual Methodologies: An Introduction to the Interpretation of Visual Materials, Gillian Rose Transglobal Fashion Narratives: Clothing Communication, Style Statements and Brand Storytelling Fashion at the Edge, Caroline Evans Visual Research Methods in Fashion, Julia Gaimster	

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

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